

THE ENTERPRISE AGENTIC PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE

Control, Runtime, Experience, and Capability Planes for Governed AI Adoption

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The decision is not whether to adopt agentic AI.
That is already happening on its own momentum.

The decision is whether the enterprise governs how that capability composes, or accepts whatever composition emerges by default.

Individual agentic products work. What fails is the enterprise's ability to govern how they compose: identity does not flow from one agent to the next, authorization is enforced inconsistently, evidence scatters across logs that do not correlate.

THE THREAT

When the human leaves the keyboard, accountability leaves with it

UNGOVERNED

A copilot adjusts a financial record under whatever credentials it inherited.

An auditor asks: who authorized this, and under what policy?

The answer is reconstructed by hand across disconnected logs. Often inconclusively.

GOVERNED

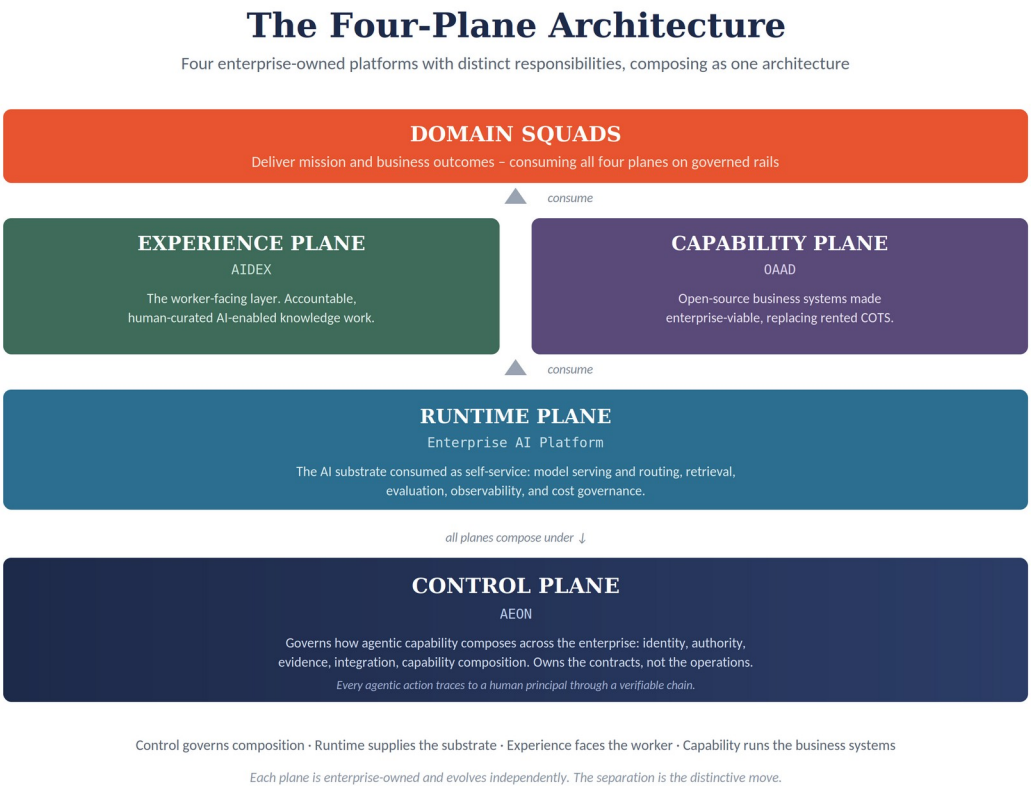
Identity binds the action to the human principal who invoked it.

Authority evaluates whether that principal may act, and routes for confirmation if consequential.

Evidence records principal, decision, and result in one correlated chain.

The audit question is answered definitively. The mis-authorized action is caught before it happens.

Four planes, enterprise-owned, each with a distinct responsibility



The market just proved us right about the what. It is dodging the who.

CONSENSUS NOW

Google Cloud Next and **SAP Sapphire** both repositioned around an agentic **control plane** — agent identity, registry, governance, observability as core capabilities. Tier-one analysts now frame the buyer's decision as an operating-model choice, not a tooling choice.

THE QUESTION THEY WON'T ANSWER

Every vendor control plane is one you **rent**. The center is the vendor's platform. None argues the control plane should be enterprise-owned, because none has the incentive to.

This convergence makes the control-plane problem consensus. It does not make enterprise ownership consensus. That gap is where this architecture lives.

Sources: Google Cloud Blog (Apr 2026); SAP News Center (May 2026); Bain & Company (Apr 2026). May 2026 snapshot.

Two differentiators the vendor convergence cannot erase

01

Ownership

A rented control plane is an exit you do not control.

For an enterprise whose sovereignty or regulatory posture makes vendor governance over its own operations unacceptable, ownership is the whole question — and the market left it unanswered.

02

Four-plane holism

The landscape has pieces. It has nothing that composes all four as one owned architecture.

And it has nothing resembling the capability plane — because no business-system vendor can sell the displacement of its own business.

No business-system vendor can sell you the path off itself.

SAP cannot sell an enterprise the path off SAP. Salesforce cannot sell the path off Salesforce. The incumbents are doing the opposite: using the agentic transition to **tighten** the cage.

SAP, 2026 API policy

Third-party agents reach SAP data only through SAP-mediated agents, on a protocol SAP defines, governs, and meters.

SAP CEO, investor call

Reserves the right to throttle high-volume agent traffic; calls SAP's domain knowledge "a great asset to protect."

Forrester, May 2026

Characterized the move as an attempt to become "the gatekeeper of enterprise AI."

Only the enterprise has the incentive to own the capability layer. That makes it the one differentiator that will not erode as the market matures.

Sources: C. Klein (SAP CEO) investor call via The Register (Apr 2026); SAP 2026 API policy; Forrester (May 2026). Salesforce and ServiceNow have not imposed equivalent hard restrictions.

Capabilities as the unit of analysis, not a list of tools

Tier 1 Enterprise Business Capability Model

Business capabilities as the unit of analysis. Ownership posture and displacement phase, not a software inventory.

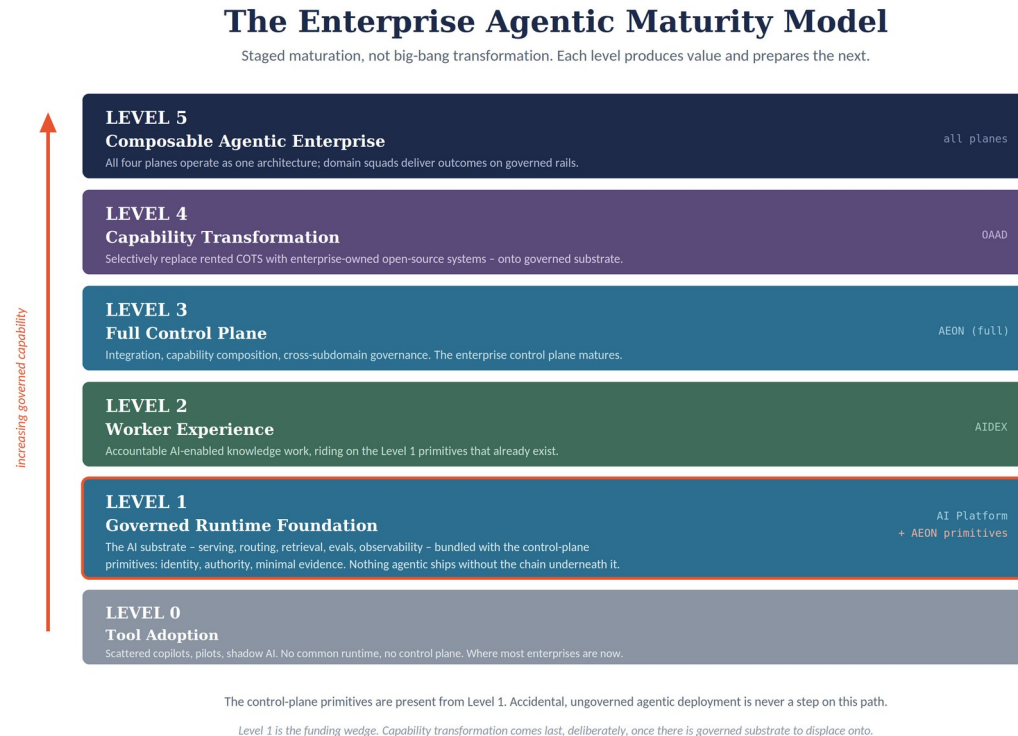
Business Capability	Typical System Today	Ownership	Displacement Candidacy	Phase
IT Service Management Incident, change, CMDB, request fulfillment	ServiceNow	Rented	High - low entanglement, mature OSS	1
Software Delivery & SDLC CI/CD, source, sprint, release management	Jira / ServiceNow SPM	Rented	High - highest engineering tolerance	1
Collaboration & Communications Messaging, meetings, knowledge, content	M365 / Teams	Rented	Moderate - integrates with hyperscaler edge	1
Customer Relationship Mgmt Accounts, pipeline, sales, service	Salesforce	Rented	Moderate - data-rich, agentic lock-in tightening	2
Human Capital Management Onboarding, talent, workforce analytics	Workday / SuccessFactors	Rented	Moderate - some regulated sub-domains	2
Data & Analytics BI, reporting, anomaly detection	Tableau / Power BI	Rented	High - mature OSS, agent-friendly	2
Enterprise Resource Planning Procurement, financial close, supply chain	SAP / Oracle	Rented	Lower - deep entanglement, hardest case	3
Security & GRC Threat ops, compliance, risk scoring	Splunk / Archer	Rented	Moderate - accreditation-sensitive	3
Out of scope by design Regulated/accredited systems (payroll, treasury, FDA/HIPAA/ITAR-bound), hyperscaler foundational services (identity, email), and specialized engineering instruments (CAD, EDA, MBSE authoring). The architecture integrates with these; it does not displace them.				

Reading the model:
Candidacy reflects entanglement, OSS maturity, and regulatory exposure - **green high** , **amber moderate/lower**
Phase is the maturity-model level at which displacement is prudent, never before governed substrate exists:
Phase 1 lowest entanglement first - **Phase 2** data-rich mid-tier - **Phase 3** deepest entanglement last

No business-system vendor can offer this model. Displacement of the rented stack is structurally against their interest; only the enterprise has the incentive to own it.

Candidacy is assessed per capability in discovery, not assumed. Open-source equivalence in the hardest domains remains a claim to be proven, not granted.

A staged path, not a four-platform megaproject



THE LEVEL 1 RULE

No production agentic capability without identity binding, authority decisioning, and evidence capture.

Ungoverned agentic deployment is never a step on the path.
Each level produces value on its own and prepares the next.

From integrating rented intelligence to owning it

YESTERDAY

COTS management & integration

Unit of work: the vendor seam

Core skill: procurement & integration

Intelligence accrues to: the vendor



THE AGENTIC ERA

AI-enabled platform lifecycle ownership

Unit of work: the owned platform

Core skill: platform engineering & governance

Intelligence accrues to: the enterprise

“Rented intelligence” is the operational learning, every refined workflow and handled edge case, that today accrues inside the vendor's platform rather than the enterprise's. A shift in the center of gravity, not a total replacement: vendor management persists as a supporting activity; platform lifecycle ownership becomes the defining one.

This is not a universal prescription

BUILD & OWN WHEN

- Classified or mission systems
- Regimes requiring first-party auditability of all agentic operations
- Sovereignty exposure that makes vendor governance unacceptable

RENT INSTEAD WHEN

- Low regulatory and sovereignty exposure
- Time-to-first-capability matters more than ownership
- Cannot sustain the multi-year horizon or senior-talent commitment

Either way: do not pass through a stage of ungoverned agentic capability. The primitives belong in place before agents act, whoever owns the platform underneath.

The risks, named rather than buried

OSS-equivalence is the softest link

Mature open-source alternatives exist for nearly every domain; enterprise-equivalence under real load in the hardest domains is a claim to prove in discovery, not grant.

The cost of separation is real and recurring

Four-plane separation internalizes integration work a single vendor would absorb. It is the price of ownership and governability — paid knowingly.

The build-vs-rent bar has risen

Six months ago an owned control plane competed against nothing comparable. Today it competes against polished vendor control planes shipping now.

The moat deserves the same scrutiny as the vendor critique

Owned institutional intelligence is a strong argument against the rental model; whether it is a defensible moat warrants the same standard of evidence.

None of these is disqualifying. Each is a reason to proceed deliberately, to stage the commitment, and to keep the falsifiable claims under genuine test.

Fund Level 1 and a short discovery. Not the full transformation.

COMMIT NOW

- **Fund the governed runtime**

AI substrate plus identity, authority, evidence. Target: governed deployments with a complete evidence chain in 6–12 months.

- **Authorize a focused discovery**

Replace directional targets with the enterprise's own numbers, in weeks.

- **Architect governance first**

Primitives and contracts before any agent acts in production.

PRE-COMMIT FOR LATER

Contingent on discovery and Level 1 results

- **The institutional function and the multi-year horizon**

Central architecture authority, investment tolerance, senior talent.

Test the commitment honestly in discovery, not in full today. An enterprise that cannot meet the preconditions should stop at the value Level 1 delivers.

The first step is modest and self-justifying. The sequence after it is clear and conditional. The decision is whether to begin.

01

Never trust the AI.

Treat it as an untrusted actor. Trust nothing it does that you cannot verify, authorize, and audit.

02

Overtake AI, or it will overtake you.

Own the agentic layer before vendors, pilots, and shadow automation own it for you.